

by AI efficiently handle queries and resolve basic operational issues. By offering round-the-clock support, AI ensures a seamless client experience.

Take for example ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund's use of AI. "We've implemented AI-driven solutions across various functions, including automated customer service and intelligent virtual assistants," says Abhijit Shah, Head of Marketing, Digital, and Customer Experience at the asset management company.

AI is also making document verification and fraud prevention easier. AI tools speed up the process, verifying documents quickly and accurately. Additionally, AI helps spot fraud by analysing transaction patterns and market data in real time. It can identify unusual activities that may signal fraud.

Technology, which is already helping in streamlining operations and increasing accessibility, has the potential to further enhance decision-making of investors.

"As technology evolves, its potential to deliver customised, data-driven advice and improve efficiency will redefine the investor experience," says Himanshu Kohli, Co-founder of Client Associates, a wealth management company.

And how will AI achieve that? Kohli is of the opinion that AI will enhance decision-making for wealth advisors by providing real-time market insights.

The advent of robo-advisors is also driven by technological advances and AI. As Indian investors embrace digital solutions, robo-advisors are reshaping wealth management by offering tailored, data-driven services. "While robo-advisors have already gained significant traction in the US, their adoption in India is on the rise, supported by the growing demand for affordable, tech-enabled financial advisory services," says Abhijit Roy, Co-founder and CEO of GoldenPi Securities, a Sebi-licensed debt broker.

RISE OF DIGITAL LENDING

AI is also revolutionising digital lending by improving the evaluation of creditworthiness. Traditional methods of assessing creditworthiness often rely on credit reports and bank statements, which may not offer a complete picture, especially for new or underbanked customers. AI can, however, analyse a broader range of data.

Anil Sinha, CTO of Fibe, a digital lending platform, explains, "Fibe uses advanced AI/ML algorithms to create tailored lending experiences. By analysing customer profiles and financial behavior, we recommend the most suitable financial products."

AI is also enhancing decision-making in areas like healthcare loans. Fibe's 'Doctor AI' tool analyses medical bills and invoices, making it easier to process healthcare financing applications.



"While AAs don't use AI themselves, their consent-based data-sharing system creates a foundation for AI-powered solutions that add value"

B.G. MAHESH
CEO, SAHAMATI



"As technology evolves, its potential to deliver customised, data-driven advice, and improve efficiency will redefine the investor experience"

HIMANSHU KOHLI
CO-FOUNDER, CLIENT ASSOCIATES

LOOKING AHEAD

While AI is transforming how investors interact with financial services, limitations remain. Kohli notes, "It [AI] lacks the ability to account for emotional nuances and struggles with the dynamic aspirations of individuals. During unprecedented market events, its reliance on historical data may lead to errors. Moreover, excessive reliance on AI tools can lead to missed opportunities, and investors with limited financial knowledge may find AI-generated insights overly complex." Hence, balancing AI with human input is crucial.

Shah of ICICI MF, also points out, "AI has the potential to revolutionise the way investors make financial decisions. However, it should always be used in conjunction with human expertise. A balanced approach, combining the strengths of both human and artificial intelligence, will ensure the best possible outcomes for investors."

Gone are those days when one had to stand in lengthy queues to get even the tiniest amount of information. But as with many great inventions, AI also requires further adjustments to make the technology error-free and more accessible to non-urban areas. Is 2025 the year it fulfills that target? That remains to be seen. **BT**

@teena_kaushal